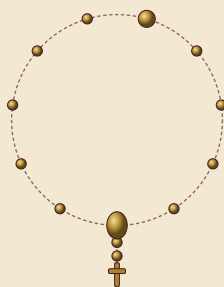


AN ILLUSTRATED FIELD MANUAL

Rosary Yoga

The Ten Poses, Drawn

a nightly anchor for body, mind, and the work ahead



A complete picture of the nightly practice: five opening poses to settle the body and mind, and five deep holds to repeat across the five decades of the rosary. Same poses, same order, every night — the body learns the cue, the mind follows the bead.

♦ THIRTY TO FORTY MINUTES ♦ BEFORE SLEEP ♦

How the Rosary Becomes a Practice

The rosary has fifty-nine beads, divided into an opening pendant and five decades around the loop. Each bead is a prayer; each prayer holds a pose. The body is moved not by counting seconds but by counting prayers.

THE OPENING PENDANT

CROSS · 1 BEAD · 3 BEADS · 1 BEAD · MEDALLION

Five poses — the body is settled, the mind is given a thread.

Roughly twelve to fifteen minutes.

THE FIVE DECADES

EACH DECADE: 1 OUR FATHER · 10 HAIL MARYS · 1 GLORY BE

Three poses repeat — Anchor, Deep Hold, Transition.

The Anchor (Child's Pose) and the Transition (neutral on the back) are the same every decade. Only the Deep Hold changes — one of five fixed poses per decade, always in the same order.

THE FIVE DEEP HOLDS, IN ORDER

1. *Reclined Figure-Four — hips and glutes*
2. *Supported Bridge — hip flexors and chest*
3. *Happy Baby — low back and inner hips*
4. *Reclined Spinal Twist — spine and digestion*
5. *Legs Up the Wall — recovery and sleep*

The poses do not change with the day. Whether the body has been still or worked hard, the anchor stays the same — that is what makes it an anchor.

The Opening Pendant

I APOSTLES' CREED · 3–5 MIN

Seated Forward Fold

SETUP Sit on the floor with legs extended in front of you. Fold forward from the hips — soft knees if the hamstrings are tight. Let the head, shoulders, and arms hang heavy.

HOLD *A gentle pulling along the back of the legs and the length of the spine. Soft. Never forced.*



II FIRST OUR FATHER · 3 MIN

Child's Pose

SETUP Kneel and bring the big toes together. Knees can be wide or together. Sink the hips back toward the heels and stretch the arms forward. Forehead rests on the mat.

HOLD *A grounded, sheltered quality. The spine lengthens, the hips release, the breath slows.*



III THREE HAIL MARYS · 5 MIN

Supported Butterfly

SETUP Lie on the back and bring the soles of the feet together, knees falling open. Place a folded blanket or block under each knee for support. Arms rest at the sides, palms up.

HOLD *An opening through the inner thighs and front of the hips. Heavy. Yielding.*



The Opening Pendant



IV GLORY BE · 2 MIN EACH SIDE

Gentle Spinal Twist

SETUP On the back, draw the right knee toward the chest, then let it fall across the body to the left. Shoulders stay flat on the floor. Gaze softly to the right. Switch sides.

HOLD *A slow wringing through the spine and side ribs. Breath is the guide — never push past it.*



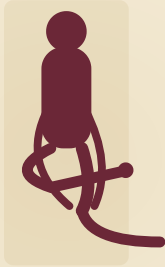
V CLOSING STILLNESS · 1–2 MIN

Savasana — Threshold

SETUP Lie flat on the back, legs extending naturally, arms slightly out from the body, palms facing up. Let everything be where it falls.

HOLD *The pause before the mysteries begin. Body held by the ground. Mind held by the breath.*

The Deep Holds



1 FIRST DECADE · TEN HAIL MARYS

Reclined Figure-Four

SETUP Lie on the back. Cross the right ankle over the left thigh, just above the knee. Draw the left thigh toward the chest, threading hands behind the left hamstring. Hold half the decade, then switch.

HOLD A deep release through the outer hip and glute of the crossed leg.



2 SECOND DECADE · TEN HAIL MARYS

Supported Bridge

SETUP Lie on the back, knees bent, feet flat. Lift the hips and slide a block or firm bolster under the sacrum (the bony plate above the tailbone). Lower the weight onto the prop. Arms rest at the sides.

HOLD An unwinding of the hip flexors and a quiet opening across the chest. The whole front body softens.



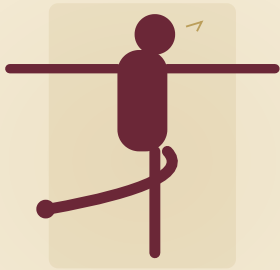
3 THIRD DECADE · TEN HAIL MARYS

Happy Baby

SETUP Lie on the back. Draw the knees toward the chest, then grab the outside edges of the feet (or the shins, or behind the knees). Stack ankles over knees and gently draw the knees toward the armpits.

HOLD A childlike decompression of the lower back and a wide opening through the hips.

The Deep Holds



4 FOURTH DECADE · TEN HAIL MARYS

Reclined Spinal Twist

SETUP On the back, draw the right knee toward the chest. Let it cross slowly to the left, shoulders staying anchored. Right arm extends out to the right; gaze follows. Switch sides halfway.

HOLD A slow, gravity-led wringing of the spine. Digestion follows. So does sleep.



5 FIFTH DECADE · TEN HAIL MARYS

Legs Up the Wall

SETUP Sit close to a wall, then swing the legs up while lowering the back to the floor. Hips can be flat or supported with a folded blanket. Stay for the full decade — this is the closing hold.

HOLD The legs flush, the heart-rate drops, the nervous system shifts toward sleep. Profoundly restful.

The Whole Practice in One Glance

OPENING PENDANT • 12–15 MIN

I	<i>Seated Forward Fold</i>	3–5 min
II	<i>Child's Pose</i>	3 min
III	<i>Supported Butterfly</i>	5 min
IV	<i>Gentle Spinal Twist</i>	2 min each side
V	<i>Savasana — Threshold</i>	1–2 min

THE DECADE PATTERN (×5) • 18–25 MIN

A	<i>Child's Pose</i>	Our Father • 1–2 min
B	<i>Deep Hold (see below)</i>	10 Hail Marys • ~5 min
C	<i>Neutral on the Back</i>	Glory Be • 1 min

THE FIVE DEEP HOLDS, IN ORDER

1	<i>Reclined Figure-Four</i>	Ten Hail Marys
2	<i>Supported Bridge</i>	Ten Hail Marys
3	<i>Happy Baby</i>	Ten Hail Marys
4	<i>Reclined Spinal Twist</i>	Ten Hail Marys
5	<i>Legs Up the Wall</i>	Ten Hail Marys

Total practice — thirty to forty minutes.
The body learns the cue; the mind follows the bead.